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Digital Passion

Fuelling The Pursuit Of Technology Knowledge

Insight

Life In The Fast Lane

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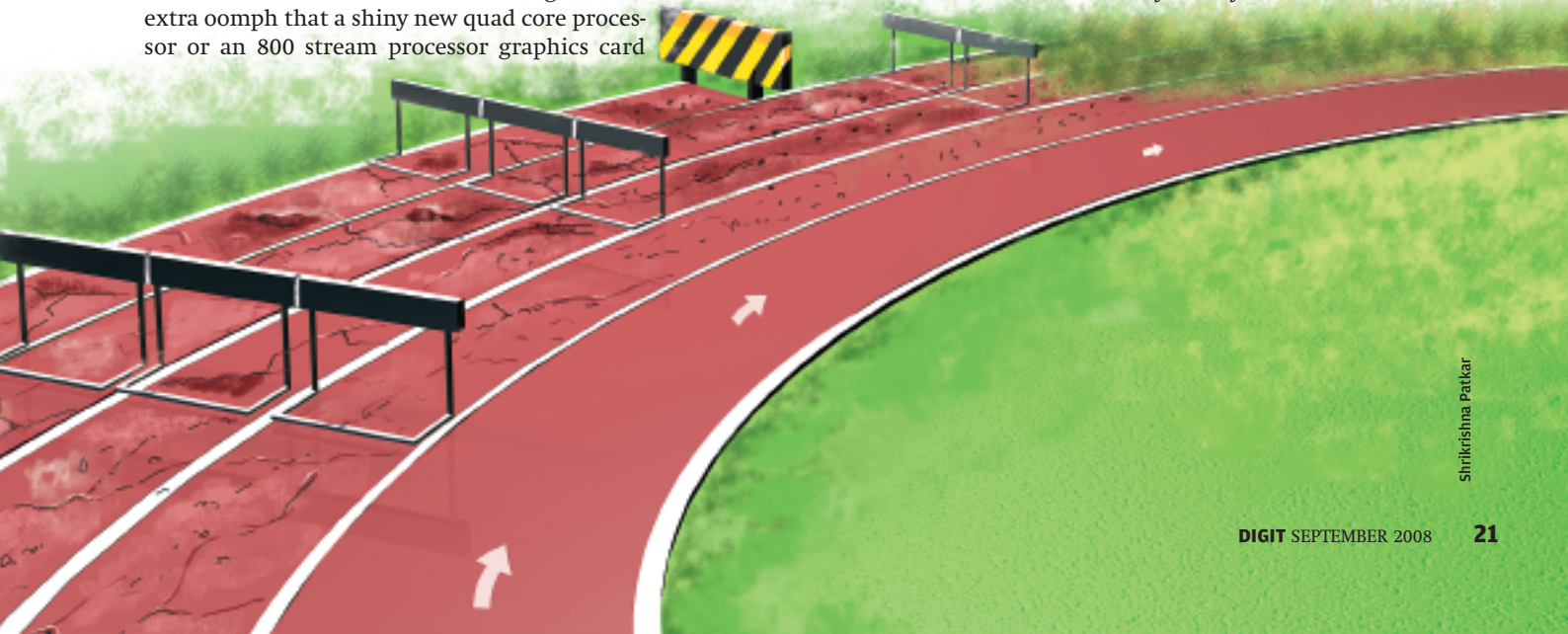
We've come a long way—from monochrome displays and complex command line syntaxes to the (then) revolutionary and simplified Start menu and Windows Explorer courtesy Windows 95, to MS Vista's 3D Aero interface. As the adage goes—technology changes everything. Today, news updates are an RSS feed away, and you can say goodbye to daily logins at www.cnn.com. Stock, weather, travel, and even calendar related data is all available as an active task pane on your desktop and the computer has become even more newbie friendly with utilities built into the latest OSes and applications. This so called *interactive* experience is taken to the next level with content like 3D games, and Blu-Ray movies—the new generation of entertainment. The animation and graphics industry, the world of cinema and content encoding and security and encryption domain all cry out for the next generation of computing hardware to accelerate productivity, reduce latency times, and satisfy our computing demands. The latest hardware available is quickly brought to its knees with taxing applications as developers code their socks off to take advantage of the extra oomph that a shiny new quad core processor or an 800 stream processor graphics card

Desktop memory has taken one more step forward, even as video memory gets its much awaited shot in the arm. The next generation is here. We answer the *what* and the *why*.

provide. So the cycle of hardware development continues. The main drivers behind this development are games, 3D modelling and animation, and multimedia and interactive content in general.

Memory is one of the performance enhancing components that enjoy a relatively longer market life, as two or three processor generations may be based around a single memory standard. For example DDR2 has been around since Pentium days. There are two types of memory in a computing system—main memory (RAM) and video memory (VRAM), which is present on graphics cards.

The acronym RAM is currently synonymous with DDR2, but this wasn't the case always. DDR RAM was its predecessor, and DDR RAM itself preceded by SD RAM. Now facing retirement, DDR2 should soon be put to pasture by one of our limelight hogs—DDR3. DDR3 is already available for purchase, but it's very costly at the moment, owing to very low market acceptance. Then there is the cost of a new motherboard to consider, and DDR3-based boards aren't cheap. Other than the odd enthusiast, DDR3 at the moment is a largely unadopted technology, but that *will* change. Industry experts believe DDR3 to become a norm sometime early next year—when manu-



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